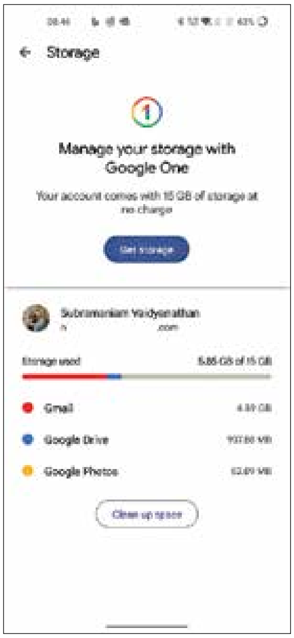

download. Most devices are configured to take regular cloud backups of your phone's gallery when you initially setup the device. While this helps with having timely backups, it can quickly take up a great deal of your limited cloud storage. There are a few ways to circumvent this:

Use the default resolution for regular snaps — Smartphones advertise up to 108 MP cameras these days, but often these are binned 12 MP images. Regular photos in good ambient light can easily make do with just the 12 MP or a corresponding mode. This can save a good deal of space both on-device and in the cloud.

Compress photos to save space — If you have already captured a high-resolution image, you may have enough scope for compression to a lower resolution without losing much detail. Many apps that automatically backup photos allow you to compress and upload them at lower quality to save on space.

Delete the "Recently Deleted" — Merely deleting local or cloud files may not be enough to recover space. Many photo and cloud apps often come with a recycle bin that store your trashed files till a definite period. If you find that your storage is not increasing despite deleting data, chances are that they are being sent to the Recently Deleted area. Check out the Recently Deleted section and select the ones you want to permanently erase.

REDUCE BACKUP SIZE

If all you want to keep is one good-looking selfie out of 99 others that didn't appeal, it's a good idea to delete those. Also, services such as Google Photos and OneDrive allow you to automatically backup your device's Camera Roll but also offer additionally flexibility in choosing other folders, so you can prevent all those memes received in WhatsApp from taking up valuable cloud space.

Depending on the service, your cloud storage provider may also offer to compress files and decompress them on-demand. This can come at a cost, however. A better idea would be to compress the files yourself before uploading them to the cloud. This can be useful for storing files that are not as frequently accessed or for archival purposes. Do note that most consumer clouds do not automatically decompress the files for viewing.

If you are a professional user running Google Cloud Services or Amazon AWS, you may be able to zip the files before uploading using the command line or console. Those using Microsoft Azure can compress files using Azure's CDN.

PAY-AS-YOU-GO CLOUDS FOR THE ENTERPRISE

In an enterprise, costs need to scale depending on requirement. Many organisations find it cheaper to deploy applications in operating systems hosted in the cloud than running them on-premise. For all these use cases, a typical cloud subscription just doesn't cut it. Enter pay-as-you-go cloud computing.

Major hyperscale cloud service providers such as Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud Platform, Amazon Elastic Compute Cloud (EC2), part of Amazon Web Services (AWS), IBM Cloud, etc. all offer pay-as-you-go solutions.

These providers also offer a free pricing tier and free credits that organisations can use to evaluate their needs before purchasing further storage or running time. AWS has been a formidable player in this segment, but Microsoft isn't too far behind. Google and IBM are catching up to these in terms of regional availability and marketshare.

These services also offer features such as object storage, which streaming services like Spotify use to deliver data on the fly. Other offered services include built-in artificial intelligence, blockchain SDKs, a host of developer tools, infrastructure-as-a-service (IaaS), platform-as-a-service (PaaS), and more. Offloading development stacks to the cloud also frees up precious organisational resources.

DELETE UNWANTED DEVICE AND APP BACKUPS

With a plethora of new smartphones and other computing devices being released almost every fortnight, users often find themselves roaming between devices and consequently, an increasing number of device backups.

If you've been on a consistent device upgrade cycle, chances are that there is probably a device backup of that iPhone 7 of yore that can occupy significant space. You probably won't be needing that if you aren't using that device anymore, so it makes sense to delete the device backup and reclaim valuable space. Also, apps such as WhatsApp can consistently back up changes to the cloud and if you have a ton of videos and multimedia, this can run into many GBs.

If cloud storage is proving to be too limiting, you can also look at other offline or personal cloud setups, which we will see next.

BACKUP THE CLOUD

Even the best services suffer downtimes. We've been seeing several instances of Cloudflare and other services suffering blackouts due to various reasons, all of which can impact access to your cloud data at the most crucial of times. Redundancy is important not only for offline storage but also in the cloud. Therefore, it is important to